

# EESC 2010 - Solid Earth Dynamics (2024 Spring)

## 1. From Big Bang to Earth Formation

### Big Bang Theory: Explanation to universe formation

- All mass and energy evolved from one infinitesimally small point
- Age of the universe: ~13.81 billion years old
- ① Expansion of the universe ② Abundance of light elements (H, He)
- ③ Cosmic Microwave Background Radiation ④ Galactic evolution distribution
- Grand Unified Theory: Era:  $10^{-43}$  -  $10^{-35}$  s [Gravity]
- Era of Inflation:  $10^{-35}$  -  $10^{-32}$  s [Strong Nuclear Force]
- Electroweak Era:  $10^{-32}$  -  $10^{-16}$  s [Weak Nuclear Force] [Electromagnetic Force]
- Particle Era:  $10^{-16}$  -  $10^{-12}$  s stabilized quarks → elementary particles
- Era of Nucleosynthesis:  $10^{-3}$  s - 3 min H, He atoms energy, photon empty space CMB
- Era of Nuclei: 3 min - 380,000 years Atoms are transparent to light
- Era of Atoms: 380,000 years - 1 billion years Fusion of atoms (gravity)
- C, N, O, etc. form supernovas
- Era of Galaxies: 1 billion years - present Galaxies, Nebulas, Stars

### Formation of Solar System

- ① Molecular cloud collapse: vast cloud of gases and dust in space collapses in slightly denser region forms an accretion disk larger clumps
- ② Protostar formation: center of collapsing cloud becomes the sun
- ③ Planetesimals and protoplanets: planetesimals → protoplanets
- ④ Formation of planets: inner planets (terrestrial, rock & metal) outer planets (gas, ice giants)

Terrestrial: Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars C gas: Jupiter, Saturn  
Ice: Uranus, Neptune Moon: All but Mercury, Venus

### Formation of Earth & Moon

Hot temperature → differentiation  
Iron core, stony mantle

Protoplanet colliding with Earth → Debris coalesce and form the moon  
Earth's surface (30% land, 70% water) Topography defines plains, mountains, valleys; Bathymetry defines mid-ocean ridges, physical plains

### Layers of the Earth

- ① Crust (thin, light) having Moho as base
- ② Mantle (thicker, denser)
- ③ Outer core (Fe)
- ④ Inner core (Fe-Ni) very dense

Chemical properties: ① Continental crust (granitic) ② Oceanic crust (basaltic)  
③ Mantle (peridotitic) ④ Core (Fe, Ni alloy)

Entire Earth: Fe, O, Si, Mg

Lithosphere: rigid, includes crust, upper mantle

Asthenosphere: soft solid near m.p. upper mantle immediately below lithosphere

## 2. Plate Tectonics

Wegener's Hypothesis: A supercontinent Pangea broke up 200 Ma ago and drifted to present locations

- ① Fit of continent shapes, geological units ② Paleoclimates e.g. plants, reefs
- ③ Glacial deposits far from polar ④ Distributions of fossils

Earth's magnetic field ① Dipole field, tilted 11.5° from axis of rotation  
Flows in outer core ② Roughly coincides with Earth's geographic pole

Declination: difference between geographic N and magnetic N  
Depends on absolute position of two poles, longitude

Inclination: angle between magnetic field line and surface  
Depends on latitude

Paleomagnetism: Cooled magma shows permanent magnetization  
with dipoles aligned with Earth's magnetic field

- ① Layered basalts records magnetic change over time
- ② Inclination and declination indicates change in position

Apparent Polar Wander: each continent has a separate polar wandering path ① Magnetic pole is fixed ② Continents have moved

Sea-floor spreading: Harry Hess

- ① Sediment thicken away from ridges / cracked crust split apart
- ② Earthquake at MOR indicate cracking — high heat flow from molten rock rises into
- ③ New ocean floor formed at MOR cracked crust
- ④ Sea floor at trenches sink back to mantle

Evidence of sea-floor spreading: Magnetic abnormalities  
differences between expected strength of the Earth's magnetic field

at a location and the observed strength of the magnetic field at that location  
Positive abnormalities: field strengths greater than expected

Negative abnormalities: field strengths weaker than expected  
Ocean floor is striped by parallel bands symmetrical on either side of MOR, age also increases along either side of MOR

Cause of magnetic reversals ① spontaneous  
② Triggered by impact events/arrival of continental slabs by plate tectonics

Plate Tectonics explain s: ① Distribution of earthquakes and volcanoes

- ② Changes in past positions of continents and ocean basins
- ③ Origins of mountain belts and seamount chains
- ④ Origin and ages of ocean basins

### Divergent Boundary ① Tectonic plate breaks apart

- a) Spreading ridge ② Lithosphere thickens away from ridge axis
- b) Continental rift ③ New lithosphere formed by rising asthenosphere

Mid-ocean ridges opens axial rift valley, rising asthenosphere melts and form mafic lava, the cooled magma solidifies into oceanic crustal rock

Pillow basalt: magma quenched at seafloor Dike: preserved magma conduits  
Gabbro: deeper magma "Black smokers": water enters fractured rock, heated

to dissolve minerals and bring back to sea to precipitate (high S content)

Convergent Boundary ① Tectonic plates moves together

- a) Volcanic island arc ② One plate sinks back into mantle
- b) Continental volcanic arc - Subducting plate is always oceanic crust (thin, dense, basaltic)
- c) Continental collision

③ Must be followed with sea-floor spreading

Features: ① Deep-ocean trenches ② Accretionary prisms  
③ Volcanic arcs ④ Back-arc basins

Volcanic Arc: a chain of volcanoes on overriding plate  
Oceanic plate adds; volatile content lowering m.p. of mantle

Continental crust - continental arc Oceanic crust - island arc

① Subduction trenches forms where the subducting plate bends downward into mantle.

② Sediments accumulated on the crust of subducting plate are scraped off onto the edge of the overriding plate, creating a wedge-shaped "accretionary prisms".

③ Magma created by melted subducting plate heated up by magma rises through the overriding plate and creates lava.

Several volcanoes formed parallelly in a chain called "volcanic arcs".

④ Forms between an island arc and continent, offshore subduction traps a piece of oceanic crust, or stretching lithosphere creates a new spreading ridge.

Suture - boundary between two once separated plates

Continental Collision  
Continental lithosphere is too buoyant to subduct  
Collision deforms crust, mountains are uplifted

Transform Boundary ① Tectonic plates slide sideways  
a) fracture zone ② No plate formed/consumed  
b) plate margin

Triple Junctions point where three plate boundaries intersect

Hot spots plumes of deep mantle material independent of plates  
deep mantle plume partially melts lithosphere, rises to surface

Plate motion pulls volcano off plume, forming a chain of extinct volcanoes called hot spot track. Reinforces sea floor spreading

Ridge-push: elevated MOR push lithosphere away

Slab-pull: denser subducting plate is pulled downward

3. Minerals ① Naturally occurring ② Inorganic ③ Solid

④ Orderly crystalline structure ⑤ Chemical formula

Diamond - Covalent bonds Graphite - Van der Waals force

Tetrahedral skeleton - Sheet layers

Hardness 10 Fe, Mg, Al, K, Na

Silicate minerals: ① Ferromagnesian mafic silicate minerals

② Non-ferromagnesian felsic silicate minerals

③ Native elements (Copper, Gold)

④ Oxides (O<sup>2-</sup>) (Hematite, Limonite)

⑤ Halides (Cl<sup>-</sup>, F<sup>-</sup>) (Fluorite, Halite)

⑥ Sulfides (S<sup>2-</sup>) (Pyrite, Galena)

⑦ Carbonates (CO<sub>3</sub><sup>2-</sup>) (Calcite, Dolomite)

⑧ Sulfates (SO<sub>4</sub><sup>2-</sup>) (Gypsum, Anhydrite)

Formation of New Minerals

1. Solidification of a melt 2. Precipitation from solution

3. Chemical reaction at high temperature and pressure

4. Precipitation from a gas 5. Biomineralization

Physical properties ① Color ② Crystal shape ③ Magnetic property

④ Fluorescence ⑤ Effervescence (reactive with acid)

⑥ Streak: color of powder produced by crushing

⑦ Luster: the way of a mineral scatter light

Metallic, Vitreous, Dull, Pearly, Resinous, Waxy, Silky

⑧ Cleavage: planes of weak bonds in minerals where the mineral will break and leave a smooth surface

⑨ Fracture: Minerals without cleavage can develop irregular or conchoidal fractures.

⑩ Hardness:

1 Talc 2 Gypsum 3 Calcite 4 Fluorite 5 Apatite

6 Feldspar 7 Quartz 8 Topaz 9 Corundrum 10 Diamond

## 4. Rocks ① Naturally formed ② Solid mass of minerals or aggregates

Held together by ① cements (minerals precipitated from water and filling the gap) - clastic

② interlocking crystals - crystalline

Igneous rocks formed by cooling of a melt solidifies at ~1100-650°C

Extrusive igneous rocks / volcanic rocks: lava-flow, pyroclastic debris

Solidified rapidly → fine grained

Intrusive igneous rocks / plutonic rocks: intrusion (dike/sill)

Solidified relatively slow → coarse-grained

Texture ① Phanitic: crystals large enough to be seen by naked eye

② Aphanitic: crystals are too fine to be seen by naked eye

③ Porphyritic: large crystals in fine-grained mass

④ Glassy: superfast cooling preventing any crystallization

⑤ Vesicular: volatiles rapidly evolves due to depressurization

Tuff: fragmented mineral (K-feldspar, Quartz) fine grained

Molten rocks ① Pressure release ② heat transfer

③ volatile addition (CO<sub>2</sub>, H<sub>2</sub>O, SO<sub>2</sub>)

Magma transport ① Density: Magma is less dense than rocks

② Overlying and confining pressure squeezes magma upward

Viscosity: ① Temperature ② silica content ③ Volatile

Clastic Sedimentary Rocks

① Weathering: a) physical disintegration b) chemical decomposition

c) Solid particles + ions + soluble materials

fragments, clays, cations, soluble silica

② Erosion: sediments being removed from parent rock

③ Transportation: gravity, wind, water, ice

water energy ↑, grain size ↓ water volume ↑ amount ↑ distance ↑, roundness ↑

④ Decomposition: settle out of the transporting fluid

⑤ Lithification: compaction, dewatering, cementation

→ clastic sedimentary rock

Properties: clast size, roundness, sorting, composition

Implications: Source, deposition environment

well-sorted → far from source poorly-sorted → close to source

Breccia - Talus Sandstone - Dune

Conglomerate - River channels Arkose - Alluvial fan

Silt → siltstone

Mud → mudstone/shale

Quartz water setting

Non-clastic sedimentary rocks

Biochemical: derived from shells of living organisms

skeletons calcite/aragonite → limestone

plankton shells → chalk

marine plankton silica → chert

Organic: made of organic carbon / living things

fossil → coal

Chemical: Precipitate / evaporate from water solution

precipitates: limestone (CaCO<sub>3</sub>), dolomite (CaMg(CO<sub>3</sub>)<sub>2</sub>), chert (SiO<sub>2</sub>)

evaporates: halite (NaCl) gypsum (CaSO<sub>4</sub> · 2H<sub>2</sub>O)

Diagenesis sediments buried → lithification

↑ P, ↑ T ~300°C metamorphism begins

→ chemical reactions (ground hot water)

→ precipitate / dissolve

Metamorphic rocks

Temperature and pressure are high

enough to "cook" rocks but not enough to melt rocks

reactive fluids → structural / mineralogical changes

① Contact metamorphism: heat from magma → non-foliated

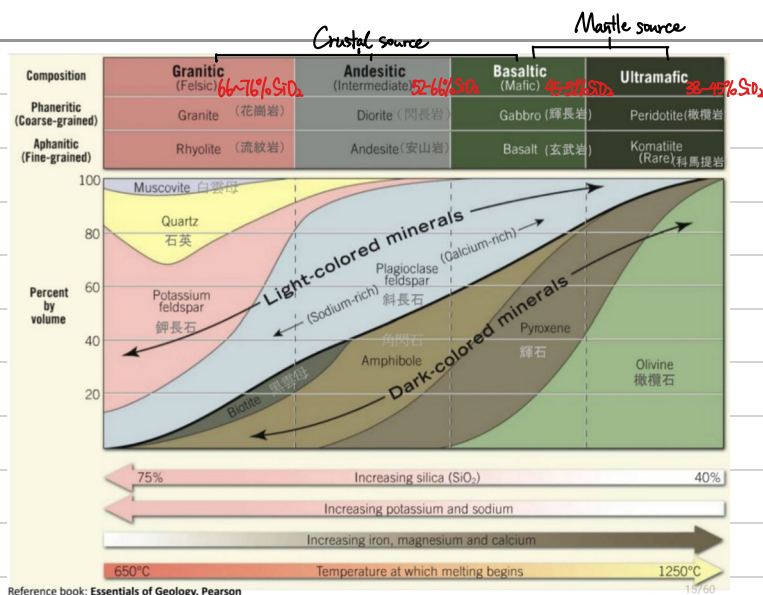
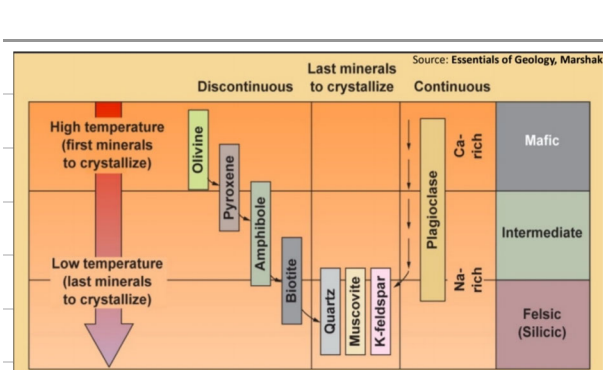
② regional metamorphism: high pressure over a range of temperature

Shield: large region of ancient high-grade rocks exposed

5. Volcanoes

Vent / opening where fragments of solidified melt and gas emerge from underground





| Minerals                     | Category                                    | Composition                                                                               | Color                          | Streak         | Luster   | Hardness | Crystal Shape       | Cleavage                   |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------|----------|----------|---------------------|----------------------------|
| Olivine                      |                                             | (Mg, Fe) <sub>2</sub> SiO <sub>4</sub>                                                    | green                          | white          | vitreous | 6-7      | orthorhombic        | none                       |
| Augite (Pyroxene Group)      | Ferromagnesian mafic silicate minerals      | (Mg, Fe)SiO <sub>3</sub>                                                                  | greenish black                 | greyish-green  | pearly   | 6        | monoclinic          | two planes at 90°          |
| Hornblende (Amphibole Group) |                                             | Ca <sub>2</sub> (Mg, Fe) <sub>5</sub> (Si) <sub>8</sub> O <sub>22</sub> (OH) <sub>2</sub> | black                          | white          | vitreous | 5-6      | prismatic, columnar | two planes at 60°/120°     |
| Biotite (Mica Group)         |                                             | K(Mg, Fe) <sub>3</sub> AlSi <sub>3</sub> O <sub>10</sub> (OH) <sub>2</sub>                | dark brown                     | white to grey  | vitreous | 2-3      | monoclinic          | 1 set of perfect cleavage  |
| Muscovite (Mica Group)       | Non-ferromagnesian felsic silicate minerals | KAl <sub>2</sub> (Si <sub>3</sub> AlO <sub>10</sub> )(OH) <sub>2</sub>                    | colorless                      | white          | vitreous | 2.5-3    | monoclinic          | 1 set of perfect cleavage  |
| K-feldspar (Feldspar Group)  |                                             | KAlSi <sub>3</sub> O <sub>8</sub>                                                         | pink                           | white          | vitreous | 6        | triclinic           | two planes at 90°          |
| Plagioclase (Feldspar Group) |                                             | (Na, Ca)AlSi <sub>3</sub> O <sub>8</sub>                                                  | white                          | white          | vitreous | 6        | triclinic           | two planes at 90°          |
| Quartz                       |                                             | SiO <sub>2</sub>                                                                          | Pure: colorless<br>Pink/Purple | white          | vitreous | 7        | hexagonal           | none (conchoidal fracture) |
| Calcite                      | Carbonates                                  | CaCO <sub>3</sub> (react with acid)                                                       | colorless or white             | white          | vitreous | 3        | hexagonal           | three planes               |
| Pyrite                       | Sulfides                                    | FeS <sub>2</sub>                                                                          | yellow                         | greenish-black | metallic | 6-6.5    | cubic               | none                       |
| Magnetite                    | Oxides                                      | Fe <sup>2+</sup> Fe <sup>3+</sup> O <sub>4</sub> (magnetic)                               | black to dark grey             | black          | metallic | 5.5-6    | cubic               | none                       |
| Diamond                      | Native Elem                                 | C                                                                                         | Transparent                    | colorless      | vitreous | 10       | isometric           | perfect octahedral         |

| Igneous Rocks | Category         | Color                 | Structure                           | Texture                    | Composition                                                                                               |
|---------------|------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Granite       | E / Felsic       | light-colored         | crystalline, massive                | phaneritic                 | Quartz, Al-rich feldspar, K-feldspar ± (mica and amphibole)                                               |
| Rhyolite      | I / Felsic       | light-colored         | crystalline, massive or flow-banded | aphanitic                  | Quartz and alkali feldspar ± ferromagnesian minerals (e.g. biotite, amphibole)                            |
| Diorite       | E / Intermediate | mix of dark and white | crystalline, massive                | phaneritic, coarse-grained | Quartz (< 10%), Na-rich plagioclase feldspars and ferromagnesian minerals (e.g. pyroxenes and hornblende) |
| Andesite      | I / Intermediate | grey or dark-colored  | crystalline, massive                | aphanitic                  | Na-rich plagioclase feldspar, augite, orthopyroxene and hornblende                                        |
| Gabbro        | E / Mafic        | dark-colored          | crystalline, massive                | phaneritic                 | Ca-rich plagioclase feldspar, pyroxene                                                                    |
| Basalt        | I / Mafic        | dark-colored          | crystalline, massive                | aphanitic                  | plagioclase feldspar, pyroxene ± olivine and magnetite                                                    |
| Pumice        | E / Felsic       | light-colored         | vesicular and glassy                |                            | SiO <sub>2</sub>                                                                                          |
| Obsidian      | E / Felsic       | dark-colored          | conchoidal, flow-banded             | glassy                     | SiO <sub>2</sub>                                                                                          |
| Peridotite    | E / Ultramafic   | dark-colored          | coarse-grained                      |                            | olivine, pyroxene                                                                                         |

E=Extrusive (Volcanic), I=Intrusive (Plutonic)

| Metamorphic Rocks     | Structure    | Foliation          | Grain size                     | Mineral Content                     | Parent Rock                                              |
|-----------------------|--------------|--------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Slate (low-grade)     | foliated     | slaty cleavage     | very fine-grained              | clay minerals, micas                | shale, mudstone                                          |
| Phyllite (low-grade)  | foliated     | phyllitic cleavage | fine-grained                   | quartz, micas, feldspar             | shale, mudstone, slate                                   |
| Schist (medium-grade) | foliated     | schistosity        | coarse-grained                 | micas, elongated quartz, hornblende | shale, mudstone, carbonates, mafic igneous rocks         |
| Gneiss (high-grade)   | foliated     | gneissic banding   | coarse-grained                 | feldspar, quartz, hornblende, micas | shale, mudstone, sandstone, felsic & mafic igneous rocks |
| Marble                | non-foliated | /                  | medium to coarse grained       | calcite, dolomite (react with acid) | limestone, dolostone                                     |
| Quartzite             | non-foliated | /                  | massive, granular, crystalline | quartz (very hard)                  | quartz sandstone                                         |
| Hornfel               | non-foliated | /                  | fine-grained                   | variable                            | shale, clay-rich rocks                                   |

| Clastic Sedimentary Rocks     | Clast Size                   | Texture / Structure   | Roundness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Sorting       |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Conglomerate                  | coarse-grained               | massive               | rounded to subangular                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | poorly-sorted |
| Breccia                       | coarse-grained               | massive               | angular                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | poorly-sorted |
| Sandstone                     | medium to coarse-grained     | coarse, massive       | /                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | well-sorted   |
| Siltstone                     | fine-grained                 | massive               | /                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | well-sorted   |
| Shale                         | very fine-grained            | laminated and fissile | /                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | well-sorted   |
| Non-clastic Sedimentary Rocks | Texture / Structure          | Composition           | Formation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |               |
| Chert                         | crystalline, massive, smooth | quartz                | Usually biogenic, volcanogenic or diagenetic origin. Form by chemical precipitation at deep sea; Sediments from marine plankton silica skeletons; Microcrystals of SiO <sub>2</sub> grow within soft sediments, grow into irregular nodules and deposit into a quiet environment |               |
| Limestone                     | Granular, crystalline        | CaCO <sub>3</sub>     | Clastic: Form by cementation of sand- to clay-sized with calcite; Biochemical: Sediments from hard mineral skeletons of dead marine animals; Chemical: Form by chemical precipitation at shallow marine or lake environments                                                     |               |

## MOST STABLE

Iron oxide (hematite)

Aluminum hydroxides (gibbsite)

Quartz

Clay minerals

Muscovite mica

Potassium feldspar

Biotite

Albite (Na-rich feldspar)

Amphiboles

Pyroxene

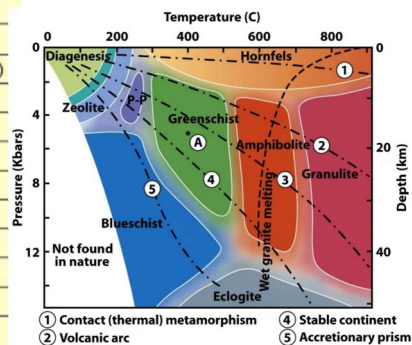
Anorthite (Ca-rich feldspar)

Olivine

Calcite

Halite

## LEAST STABLE





## 6. Geological Time Scale

### Dating geological materials

- ① Relative ages: order of formation
- ② Numerical ages: actual number of years since an event

### Relative dating techniques

Principle of **Uniformitarianism**: James Hutton. All the geological processes (weathering, erosion, volcanism, earthquakes) that happen today also occurred in the past in the same ways.

Principle of **Original Horizontality**: Sediments settle out of a fluid by gravity, causing the sediments to accumulate horizontally. Tilted sedimentary rocks must be deformed.

Principle of **Superposition**: In an undeformed sequence of layered rocks each bed is older than the one above and younger than the one below.

Principle of **Lateral Continuity**: Strata form laterally continuous sheets, extending in all directions, unless being broken up or displaced by lateral events (e.g. erosion).

Principle of **Cross-cutting Relations**: younger features cut across older features, i.e. faults and dikes are younger.

**Baked Contacts**: An igneous intrusion metamorphoses the base rock. Principle of **Inclusions**: Fragments of one rock type contained in another rock type are older than the rock that are embedded in. Younger rock contains the inclusions.

Principle of **Fossil Succession**: fossils are preserved in sedimentary rocks such that the presence of index fossils can be diagnostic of particular geologic time and can be used to correlate strata globally.

**Unconformities**: a time gap in rock record, caused by

- ① Erosion
- ② Non-decomposition.

#### A. Angular Unconformities

- Horizontally parallel strata of sedimentary rocks are deposited on tilted eroded layers.

- ① Strata deformed by folding
- ② Mountains eroded completely
- ③ New marine invasion
- ④ New sediments deposited

#### B. Nonconformity

- Igneous/metamorphic rocks capped by sedimentary rocks

#### C. Disconformity

- non-decomposition between parallel sedimentary strata due to an interruption in sedimentation
- Pause in deposition
- Sea level falls and rises
- Erosion
- Often hard to recognize

**Stratigraphic correlation** describes the sequence of strata

- Lithologic correlation (matching rock types) is regional
- Fossil correlation is based on fossils within the rocks (bracketing Earth history)

### Geologic Column

- Eons
  - Hadean: "hell" (4.6-3.8 Ga)
  - Archean: "ancient" (3.8-2.5 Ga)
  - Proterozoic: "first life" (2.5-0.542 Ga)
  - Phanerozoic: "visible life" (0.542-0 Ma)
- Life first appeared ~3.8 Ga
- Single-celled
- Cyanobacteria build up  $O_2$  in atmosphere
- Eras of Phanerozoic Eon
  - Paleozoic - "ancient life"
  - Mesozoic - "middle life"
  - Cenozoic - "recent life"

- Epoch
  - Holocene current
- Anthropocene: when humans have substantial impact on Earth
- Cambrian life explosion

**Geochronology**: radioactive decay of atoms in minerals acts as internal clocks

**Radioactive decay**: exponential  $N(t) = N_0 e^{-\lambda t}$

After one half-life  $t_{1/2}$ , half of the parent isotope remains

Key assumptions: ① Mineral grains containing the isotope formed at the same time as the rock

② Mineral crystals remain a closed system

<sup>238</sup>U can be used to date oldest minerals found on Earth

even meteorites and materials from earliest events in solar system

<sup>14</sup>C is useful for dating archaeologically important samples containing organic substances like wood or bones. <sup>14</sup>C is constantly being created in the atmosphere by interaction of cosmic particles with atmospheric <sup>14</sup>N. When an organism is alive, ratio of <sup>14</sup>C/<sup>12</sup>C in its body does not change as  $CO_2$  is exchanged. The radiocarbon clock starts ticking as <sup>14</sup>C changes back to <sup>14</sup>N by radioactive decay, useful for objects aged  $\leq 57300$  years

### Isotopic dating process

- ① Collect unweathered rock
- ② Crush and separate designated minerals
- ③ Extract parent and daughter isotopes
- ④ Analyze parent/daughter ratio by mass spectrometer measurement

- Gives the time a mineral cooled below its closure temperature (isotopes locked inside when cooled)

- Igneous rocks: Cooling of magma, lava to solid igneous rock

- Sedimentary rocks: No. Sediments are formed by weathering and erosion of other rocks. Age determined by bracketing of numerical ages. By principle of cross-cutting, and age of adjacent igneous/metamorphic rocks

- Metamorphic rocks: Metamorphism cooking of rocks

Can span a long time different grains have different ages

Growth rings: annual layers of trees and shells

Rhythmic layering: Sediments/ice

Age of the Earth ~4.54 billion years old

Oldest rock, mineral (zircon) in ancient sandstones meteorites and moon rocks

### 7. Earthquakes

rapid release of energy as waves

Causes: ① Sudden tectonic motion along newly formed/existing

crustal fault ② Phase change in mineral structure

③ Movement of magma in volcanoes ④ Giant landslides

⑤ Hurricane/typhoon/meteorite impacts ⑥ Nuclear detonations

⑦ Human activities

Faulting generate seismic waves by

① Intact rock breaks instantly creating a fault slip

② A pre-existing fault suddenly slips again

Active faults - ongoing stresses produces motion

Inactive faults - motion that occurred in geologic past

Fault trace - fault intersecting the ground

Blind faults are invisible, not reaching the surface

Rock slide past one another along a fault, cannot happen forever

resisted by friction. ① Stick: prevents motion ② Slip: no resistance

Elastic-rebound Theory: Crust of Earth can be gradually store elastic stress that is released suddenly during earthquake

Hypocenter (focus), where fault slip occurs, usually on fault surface

Epicenter, land surface right above hypocenter

Foreshock: small tremors indicating crack development in rock

Aftershock usually follow a large earthquake

Area of slip: depends of the size of the earthquake

Displacement is greatest near the hypocenter, diminishes with distance. Fault slip is cumulative.

Waves:  $y(x,t) = A \sin \frac{2\pi}{\lambda} (x - \lambda t)$   $T = \lambda v$ ,  $f = 1/T$

Seismic waves: Body waves - pass through Earth's interior

① P-waves (primary/compressional waves)

travel by compressing and expanding material, back and forth parallel to wave direction; fastest wave

travel through solid, liquids and gases

② S-waves (secondary/shear waves)

travel by moving materials back and forth perpendicular to wave travel direction; slower than P-waves

travel through only through solids, never liquids/gases

Surface waves - travel along Earth's exterior most destructive

① R-waves (Rayleigh waves)

P-waves that intersect the land surface. Ground ripple up and down like water

② L-waves (Love waves)

S-waves that intersect the land surface; Ground moves back and forth like snake.

Seismic Wave Measurement

Seismometer - instrument that record ground motion

Horizontal: back and forth

Vertical: up and down

Seismogram wave behavior

Time: determines distance to epicenter

Time: Paper

Time: Paper

Time: Paper

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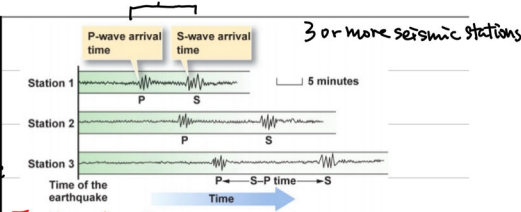
Time: Paper

Time: Paper

Time: Paper

Time: Paper

difference in time → distance



### Earthquake size

a) Intensity: severity of damage measured by

b) Magnitude: amount of ground motion. Seismometer

Mercalli Intensity Scale: amount of shaking/damage

I - low, XII - high damage occurs in zones

Richter Scale: measures maximum amplitude (A) of ground motion  $m_L = \log A + f(D) + C$

Body wave magnitude: high freq. P wave ( $> 1000$  km)

Surface wave magnitude: vertical component of R wave  $T = 20s$

Seismic Moment: measure of size that does not saturate

$M_0 = \mu D A$   $\mu$  = shear modulus  $D$  = avg. slip  $A$  = faulted area  $dyne \cdot cm$

$\log M_0 = 1.5 M_s + 16.1 \Rightarrow M_w = 0.67 \log M_0 - 10.73$

Energy:  $\log E = 1.5 M_w + 11.8$

Gutenberg-Richter Law: Magnitude v.s. total number of earthquakes in any given region and time period of at least that magnitude

$\log N = a - b M$

$a$  = # of magnitude earthquakes

$b$  is typically ~1 in seismic active regions

Earthquakes are linked to plate tectonic plate boundaries

Shallow - divergent, transform. Deep - convergent

Divergent: MBR → ① normal faults ② strike-slip faults

Normal fault ridge axis transforms

Transform: Most link segments of MBR

Some cut through continental crust (major disaster)

Convergent: Intermediate - downgoing slab still cold & brittle

Thrust faults

Deep - mineral phase changes

Seismicity of Shaking: energy

distance, frequency, ground material

Bedrock quick transmission

Sediments reflect and refract waves

Liquefaction - liquidity H<sub>2</sub>O filled sediments 1. forces grains apart

2. liquified sediments flow as slurry 3. soil loses strength 4. lands slump and flow

Prediction: ① Increase in foreshock, elevation rises ② groundwater level

Longterm Paleoseismology: prehistoric fault movements 10s

Seismic gaps: active fault lacking earthquakes warning

8. Tsunami Causes: ① Earthquakes: seafloor abruptly deforms

and vertically displaces the overlying water.

② Large tsunamis occur at convergent plate boundaries

1. Two plates collide, one plate is forced down underneath the other

2. Leading edge of the top plate snags on bottom plate and pressure builds up.

3. Pressure is released in form of earthquake

4. Earthquake occur under water; large amount of water is displaced

③ Volcanic eruption: sea waves resonate with shock waves

④ Glacier calving ⑤ Meteorite impacts ⑥ Underwater explosions

⑦ Other disturbances above/below water

Tsunami wave speed:  $v = \sqrt{gH}$  (H: depth of water)

Power of tsunami:  $P = \frac{1}{2} \rho g A^2 \sqrt{gH} = \text{constant}$

Tsunamis can be destructive because of their speed and volume. They are also dangerous as they return, carrying debris and people when they retreat.

Shallow water setting: Tsunamis reaching the coastline slow down as the bottom of the wave comes in contact with shallow sea bed. The top of the wave however continues at a high speed.



**Tsunami's Measurements:** Travel time can be measured by tidal sensors, ocean bottom sensors

- Diminishing Tsunami Hazards:**
- ① Seismic monitoring
  - ② Tsunami detection
  - ③ Land use planning
  - ④ Public education
  - ⑤ Hazard Assessment

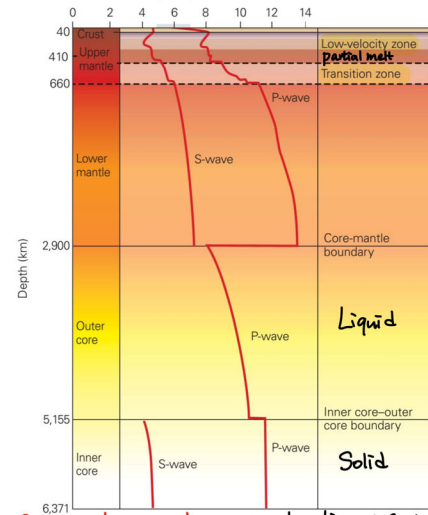
## 9. Geophysics

**Interior structures:** measuring seismic wave speed wave bend (refract) / bounce (reflect) IR

**Snell's law:**  $\frac{\sin \theta_1}{\sin \theta_2} = \frac{v_1}{v_2}$   $\sin \theta_c = \frac{v_1}{v_2}$

Velocities increases with depth → bend upwards to surface

$v_p = \sqrt{\frac{K + \frac{4}{3} \mu}{\rho}}$   $v_s = \sqrt{\frac{\mu}{\rho}}$



**Seismic tomography:** reconstructing seismic parameters by P, S waves (velocities)

- Reflection imaging:**
- ① Man-made explosion
  - ② Artificial seismic waves reflect off upper crust boundaries to oil and gas

**Gravity:**  $F = G \frac{M_1 M_2}{r^2}$ ,  $G = 6.673 \times 10^{-11} \text{ N} \cdot \text{m}^2 / \text{kg}^2$

**Equipotential surface:** on which all points have same gravitational potential energy

**Geoid:** global imaginary equipotential surface coincides with mean ocean surface

## Isostasy

**Archimedes' Principle:** any object is buoyed up by a force equal to the weight of the fluid displaced by the object.

$$H = \frac{\rho_c h}{\rho_m - \rho_c}$$

## Glacial Isostatic Adjustment

1. Lithosphere depressed, mantle flow away → subsidence
2. Ice melts at the end of glaciation → slow rebound

## Sea level and ice melting

- ① Geoid drops → sea level drops (local)
- ② water mass increase → sea level increases (global) ⇒ GLOBAL sea level rise

## 10. Crustal Deformation & Mountain Building

**Cause:** applied force > internal strength of rocks

**Result:** change in shape (strain)

**Types of stresses:** tensional - pulling apart, horizontal stretching and crustal thinning; compressional - squeezing horizontal shortening and crustal thickening; shear - surfaces slide past each other, shape change

**Types of deformation:** Factors: T (higher T, ductile), P (higher P, ductile), Rate of deformation (↑, brittle), Composition (silica, brittle)

**Ductile:** rocks permanently and continuously deformed plastic strain, deeper crust, deformed by folding

**Hinge:** a line along which curvature is greatest

**Limbs:** curved sides of a fold

**Axial plane:** a plan connecting hinges of folded layers

**Syncline:** youngest unit in core. **Anticline:** oldest unit in core

**Brittle:** rocks break by fracturing, shallower crust

**Joints:** planar fracture where blocks move apart but do not slip past each other.

**Vein:** dissolved mineral in ground water filling the joint

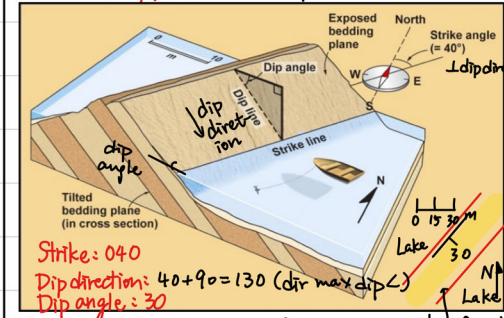
**Systematic joints** occur in parallel sets

- a) Unloading joints: when a rock mass is being brought up from deep to surface → expand and fill the space
- b) Cooling joints: contraction of hot volcanic materials

**Fault:** planar fracture or discontinuity in a volume of rock across which there has been significant displacement as a result of rock-mass movements

- ① Vertical displacement
- Normal fault (divergent) Reverse fault (convergent)
- ② Horizontal displacement
- Strike-slip fault (left/right lateral s-s fault)
- ③ Vertical + Horizontal oblique-slip fault

**Semi-ductile / Semi-brittle deformation:** break and shear



**Mountain Building:** process of generating ridge of rock maintain range horizontal shortening crustal thickening → uplift by Rocks break, bend, stretch, shear

**Compression** → deform, metamorphise

**Driven by:** collision along convergent plate boundaries

**Divergent:** continental rifting

**Associated with:** elongate, curvilinear orogenic belt

**Himalayas:** Subduction → continent-continent collision

Indian oceanic crust subducted below Eurasian continental plate → continental arc, accretionary prism

**Isostasy:**

- ① Collision → crust thickening → low mountains ↑
- ② Detachment of lithospheric mantle base → weight ↓
- Balance: ① Orogenic collapse → horizontal stretching
- ② Erosion → steep slopes, jagged mountains

## 11. Glaciers

**Ice:** solid water (H<sub>2</sub>O) forms when water cools below freezing point. Natural ice is mineral, in hexagonal crystals

**Glacial ice:** pre-existing ice recrystallise in solid state to form new crystals

**Glaciers:** thick masses of recrystallized ice

last all year long, flow via gravity, covering ~10% of Earth

Snowfall accumulates, survives the summer

→ transformed into ice

1. burial, compression reduces volume
2. Melting and recrystallization
3. Turned into granular material firm
4. Interlocking crystals of ice

Quick (10s of years) - cold

Slow (1000s of years) → climatic history

**Ice in the Sea:** ① Tidewater glaciers

valley glaciers entering the sea

② Ice shelves continental glaciers entering the sea

③ Sea ice non-glacial frozen sea

**Landscape Change:** Erosion, Transport, Deposition

**Glacier Movement:** ① Pull of gravity

② Smoothness

**Crevasse:** Surface fracture

Plastic internal deformation

**Flowspeed:** Basal sliding

surface meltwater flow from moulins

significant amount of water accumulate at glacier base, ice slide down along substrate, friction ↓

Very slow 10m-12km/year

slope, basal water, frontal condition

**Permafrost:** Ground at/below 0°C ≥ 2 consecutive years

**Active:** layer thaws and freezes annually

## 12. Global Change

Glacial Age are indicated by fossil tills and striated bedrock

• Pleistocene

• Permian

• Late Proterozoic ("snowball earth")

## Cause of Glaciation

**Plate tectonics:** ① Distribution of continents at high latitudes

② Sea level flux by MOR vol. ③ Atmospheric-Ocean Circulation

Tectonic control of CO<sub>2</sub> and atmospheric chemistry → **Hypotheses**

CO<sub>2</sub> emission and consumption - rough balance

negative feedback. Million year scale

① CO<sub>2</sub> + CaSiO<sub>3</sub> → CaCO<sub>3</sub> + SiO<sub>2</sub>

**Uplift-Weathering Hypothesis:** Uplift → fresh rock & mineral surface → strong weathering → CO<sub>2</sub> ↓ → T ↓

## ② BLAG Seafloor Rate Hypothesis

Fast seafloor spreading → rapid CO<sub>2</sub> outgassing →

Greenhouse climate → weathering ↑ → CO<sub>2</sub> burial ↑ → T ↓

**Short-term Glaciation:** Milankovitch hypothesis

Eccentricity, Tilt, Precession

Stage 1: T ↓ glaciers + Stage 3: T ↑ Glaciers -

Stage 2: Glaciers ↑, α ↓

Last Glacial Maximum: 26,500 - 19,000 years ago

Most of Northern high latitudes frozen

**Global Change:** ① Tectonic motion ② Distance to sun

③ Liquid water → weathering/erosion ④ Biotic evolution

→ Gradual / Catastrophic / Unidirectional changes

Mass extinction Meteor impacts Life evolution

→ Cyclic changes Rock, Carbon, Water, Biogeochemical

Biotic respiration Supercontinent Seal level Cycles

Volcanic CO<sub>2</sub> → atmosphere → dissolved in ocean

Rapid oxidation of organic matter → photo synthesis

metamorphism → weathering

degassing from water limestone, fossil, shales, methane hydrates

**Paleoclimates:** Stratigraphic records Oxygen and carbon isotopes

Glacial Tills - cold & continental Paleontological records Tree rings

Coral reefs - tropical marine Stratigraphic records

① water evaporates faster than <sup>18</sup>O water

**Oxygen Isotopes:** <sup>18</sup>O preferentially removed from precipitation

T ↑ ocean evaporation ↑ <sup>18</sup>O / <sup>16</sup>O ↑ glacier: T ↑ <sup>18</sup>O / <sup>16</sup>O ↑

Bubble traps the air

**Future of the Earth:** Sustainable growth

- continents reshuffled

- erosion reshape landscapes

- sea invasion

- Homo sapiens → fossils